Scan to email troubleshooting

Article KB0010078 | Owner: Desktop Support | Subcategory: Scan to email | Applies to: Multifunction printers/scanners (HP LaserJet, Xerox WorkCentre, Canon imageRUNNER, etc.), Windows 11 and macOS client workstations that initiate scans, Acme Global network (wired and Wi-Fi) including ACME-Corp and ACME-Guest SSIDs

Summary

This article helps users and service-desk agents troubleshoot the Scan-to-Email function on Acme Global's multifunction devices. It outlines common symptoms, likely causes, quick checks, a user-self-help procedure to verify and correct basic settings, and a detailed service-desk workflow for resolving persistent issues.

Symptoms

- Scan job finishes on the device but no email arrives in the recipient's inbox.
- Device LCD shows error: 'Failed to send email: SMTP authentication failed' or 'Cannot connect to SMTP server'.
- Scan-to-Email button is greyed out or returns 'Operation failed' after pressing Start.
- Email is received but contains blank attachments or corrupted files.

Common causes

- Incorrect SMTP relay host, port, or security (TLS/SSL) settings configured on the scanner.
- Sender email address or display name outdated in the device's address book.
- Authentication credentials (service account) expired, locked, or missing required permissions.
- Network firewall or proxy blocking outbound SMTP traffic on ports 25, 587, or 465.
- Device firmware outdated, causing compatibility issues with modern SMTP servers.
- Misconfigured DNS preventing resolution of the SMTP relay hostname (e.g., smtp.acme.example).

Quick Checks

Before diving into device configuration, perform these fast verifications to rule out simple issues. Ensure the scanner has network connectivity (can ping the gateway and access the Company Portal). Confirm that the intended recipient's email address is correct and that the user's mailbox is not over quota. Check the device's status panel for any error codes or messages related to email sending.

Self-Help Procedure (User)

Follow these steps to verify and correct the most common Scan-to-Email settings on the device itself. No admin rights are required beyond being able to access the device's local menu or embedded web interface.

1. 1. Wake the scanner and press the **Settings** (or **Setup**) button on the control panel.
2. Navigate to **Network Settings** -> **Email Settings** (may be labeled 'Scan to Email', 'Email Server', or 'SMTP Setup').
3. Verify the **SMTP Server** field: it should be `smtp.acme.example` (or the IP address provided by the Messaging & Collaboration team).
4. Confirm the **Port** is set to `587` for TLS (or `465` for SSL). If unsure, try both.
5. Ensure **Security Type** is set to **STARTTLS** (or **SSL/TLS** if using port 465).
6. Check the **Sender Address**: it must match a valid Acme Global mailbox, e.g., `your.name@acme.example`. Update if it shows an old alias or generic account.
7. If the device asks for a username/password, enter your Acme Global credentials (username@acme.example and your current password). Use the same password you use to log into Windows/Mac.
8. Save/apply the changes and exit the menu.
9. Place a test document in the feeder, press **Scan**, choose **Email** as the destination, enter your own email address, and start the scan.
10. Wait for the scan to complete, then check your inbox (including Junk/Spam) for the message. If you receive the email with the attached PDF/TIFF, the issue is resolved.

Service-Desk Procedure (Desktop Support)

When the self-help steps do not resolve the problem, follow this structured workflow. Gather the device details, verify

network and authentication factors, and update the scanner's SMTP configuration or address book as needed.

1. 1. Create a ticket in the ITSM system under **Printing & Scanning -> Scan to email** and assign to Desktop Support.
2. Obtain the device's make, model, serial number, and its IP address or hostname from the user or via DHCP/DNS lookup.
3. Ping the device from a management workstation to confirm reachability; note any packet loss.
4. Access the device's Embedded Web Interface (EWI) by entering its IP address in a browser (use HTTPS if available). Log in with local admin credentials (stored in the Device Passwords vault).
5. Navigate to **Email/SMTP Settings** and record the current values for Server, Port, Security, Sender Address, and Authentication.
6. Compare these values against the approved baseline documented in the Messaging & Collaboration run-book:
   - Server: `smtp.acme.example`
   - Port: `587` (TLS) or `465` (SSL)
   - Security: STARTTLS (port 587) or SSL/TLS (port 465)
   - Sender Address: a valid Acme Global mailbox (often a dedicated scanner account like `scanner@acme.example`).
   - Authentication: Username = scanner service account; Password = current password from Privileged Access Management (PAM).
7. If any field deviates, correct it to the baseline and apply/save.
8. Test the connection using the EWI's **Test Email** or **Send Test Message** function (if available). Capture success/failure.
9. If the test fails, verify network path: from a workstation, telnet to the SMTP server on the configured port (`telnet smtp.acme.example 587`) and expect a 220 response. Lack of response indicates firewall or routing issue - escalate to Network Support.
10. If the test succeeds but user scans still fail, check the device's address book for the recipient entry; ensure it matches the user's current primary SMTP address. Update or remove stale entries.
11. Perform a final user-side test scan as described in the Self-Help Procedure and confirm receipt.
12. Close the ticket with resolution notes detailing the changed setting and the test outcome.

Verification & Closure

After applying changes, confirm that the Scan-to-Email function works reliably for multiple users and document the outcome. This helps prevent recurring tickets and provides evidence for trend analysis.

When to escalate

If the SMTP test from step?9 fails (no response from smtp.acme.example on the configured port) or if the device repeatedly loses its SMTP configuration after reboot, escalate to **Network Support**. Provide the device IP, the SMTP server/port being used, results of telnet/nmap tests, and any relevant firewall logs. For issues that appear to be related to the scanner service account (locked, expired password, or missing mailbox permissions), escalate to **Identity & Access Management** after confirming the account status in Entra ID.

Keywords: scan to email, scan email not working, scanner not sending email, SMTP settings, email scan failure, printer scan to email, fax to email, scan failed, email attachment missing, printer error SMTP authentication